

MAY 2022

LIVING SAVIOR NEWSLETTER

ARTICLES TO HELP
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PASTOR ANDY'S MESSAGE

By Pastor Andy Lissy

"Jesus was in the stern, sleeping on a cushion. The disciples woke him and said to him, "Teacher, don't you care if we drown?" [Mark 4:38]

Our Lord was sound asleep in the boat as the disciples were sailing to the other side. However, this was no ordinary afternoon out on the water. They were Caught in a tremendous, sudden storm, water is about to fill the boat. Terrified they are going to drown; the disciples wake up Jesus with a sense of urgency and terror. "Teacher, don't you care that we are about to die?"

Notice that Jesus does not verbally respond to their concern. Rather Jesus just gets up, and says to the wind: "Be quiet," and to the waves, "Be still." And they obey him and the storm disappears. The disciples are besides themselves! They are astonished and they ask each other: "What kind of a man is this that even the wind and the waves obey him?"

"What kind of a man is this?" We know the answer to that question, because you and I are prone to be tossed around in stormy seas, prone to be swamped with waves which can capsized our little boat of.

With a word or the raising of his hand, he can calm our fears and give us the peace we need in those times. "What kind of a God is this?" One who calls us all to him, one who seeks us throughout our days, and one we can count on to take us home at the end of our time here.

God's Peace this Month,
Pastor Andrew C. Lissy

Vicar's Message

Easter Greetings to the Saints at Living Savior! It is truly hard to believe that I have almost reached the end of my vicarage! Veronica and I look forward to spending these final months between now and July 31st with you all – continuing to grow together in Christ!

Preaching the Lenten Wednesday sermons were a great opportunity to meditate on the Passion of our Lord. Holy Week and Easter was also a blessing by seeing so many of you and your families in attendance. Thanks be to God! Christ is Risen indeed! Alleluia!

Sophia continues to grow, very quickly I might add! She is almost three months! Please enjoy a photo or two! Again, thank you Living Savior for the way you have warmly welcomed her into the family of God and for all the blessings you have showered onto our growing family!



Even as my vicarage winds down I am continuing to do outreach to students at George Mason University. Recently I was brought into contact with a Honduran exchange student and through developing a friendship and the work of the Holy Spirit he became interested in reading the Scriptures! I was thrilled to be able to purchase a copy of the bible for him and he is now reading it with me weekly and asking many questions! Thanks be to God and please remember Diego in your prayers!

This year has been one of continual blessings and growth in my pastoral formation and I thank you all for your contributions to my education! I look forward to fellowship and worship with you all in the months to come.

In Christ,
Vicar Scot



Introducing our New Vicar- Luke Onken

"Greetings in the name of our Lord, Jesus Christ! My name is Luke Onken, and I will be your vicar at Living Savior for the 2022-2023 academic school year. I am originally from a small town in Indiana called Brownstown. Brownstown is not very well known, so I often say that I am from the neighboring town of Seymour, Indiana. Seymour is one of the most Lutheran places in the nation, with there being four different Lutheran churches all within two miles of one another! While in Seymour, I attended Immanuel Lutheran School for grades 1-8, and then Trinity Lutheran High School for my high school education. I was fortunate enough to be able to attend the University of Notre Dame for my undergraduate work. When I initially started at Notre Dame, I had



"aspirations to become a family practitioner. So, I took all the pre-med classes required and decided to major in Biological Sciences. One of the fun things I did as a biology major was participate in an ecology research lab. This lab observed how various grasses from the Chesapeake Bay grew in response to various environmental conditions. I was able to visit the Chesapeake Bay one time, during which I also explored Washington DC! My sophomore year, I decided to take on an additional Theology major because I enjoyed the content of those classes. It was in the second semester of my junior year that I decided to pursue the ministry and become a pastor. Notre Dame will always have a special place in my heart, as I root incessantly for their football team! After graduating from Notre Dame in 2022, I enrolled at Concordia Seminary. At Concordia, I enjoy playing on the seminary basketball team, serving as a representative on our Student Association, and serving at a local congregation, Zion Lutheran in Bethalto, IL.

The majority of my immediate family still lives back in Seymour. My dad works as a pilot for UPS, flying out of Louisville, KY. My mother is the secretary and catch-all for my home congregation of Peace Lutheran Church in Seymour. My older sister Sarah recently received her PhD from Hillsdale College and is married to a pastor in Seymour, Brad. They have a little girl named Ellie, and are about to welcome their second child, a boy, into the world this July. My older brother Seth works as a software engineer for Nvidia in Ann Arbor, MI. Finally, my little sister Rachel is finishing up her biochemistry major at Purdue University. My family often enjoys spending time together playing card and board games, in addition to camping and enjoying God's creation! I am excited and cannot wait to serve as your vicar!

President's / Vice President's Message

Living Savior has always been blessed with members who selflessly give of their time, talents, and treasure for the good of the church. The Nominating Committee is pleased to announce that we have a full slate of nominees to fill Board of Servant Leaders (BOSL) upcoming vacancies. Members will have the opportunity to vote on these nominees at the July 18, 2022 Voters' Assembly and their terms will be effective on August 1, 2022.

We have two remaining vacancies for Ministry Leads. The Board of Servant Leaders will vote to approve all new Ministry Lead nominations.

- The first is **Stewardship**. The focus of Living Savior's Stewardship program is to educate and encourage church members to practice good Christian stewardship. The program's content and approach to be used are up to the Stewardship committee. The committee is not bound to previous programs but may use them or create their own. For the past two years the program entailed understanding concepts and practices of faithful Christian living. The activities included a Stewardship Commitment Sunday with stewardship talks and follow-on stewardship newsletters.
- The second vacancy is a subset of the Property Ministry, which we have divided into three areas:
 - Main Building (Vacancy is filled.)
 - Vicarage/Exterior of Property (Vacancy is filled.)
 - **Preschool (Vacancy remains.)** This would entail property management of Preschool classrooms; hallways; bathrooms; playground; picnic tables; shed; and office computers. Please note that Living Savior has a full list of proven contractors we've used in the past that can handle issues that arise. The property manager would simply coordinate with them and ensure the work is done to standard at a reasonable price.

We hope you will prayerfully consider volunteering to fill these vacancies, which, among all the other ministries, are vital for accomplishing the work of the church.

Once the Nominating Committee has a full slate of nominees, we will provide the list to the congregation.

In His Service,
Deb Malone
On behalf of the Nominating Committee



Worship and Music



PRAYER AS WORSHIP

I am writing this article on Thursday, May 5. Today is “The National Day of Prayer.” It was 70 years ago that the U. S. Congress established the first Thursday in May as a National Day of Prayer. How ironic is it that our government has set aside one day a year for prayer?

As Christians, we have the privilege and blessing to pray everyday or as St. Paul says, “Pray without ceasing.” (I Thess. 5:17) Have you ever stopped to think about how much of our time together as worshipers is devoted to prayer?

There’s the prayer that some folks pray silently after they have entered the sanctuary prior to the start of the formal worship service. The “Kyrie” – “In peace let us pray to the Lord, Lord have mercy” affords us the opportunity to seek God’s mercy in our life. The Prayer of the Day helps to set and reenforce the theme of the day. On some occasions, the preacher may begin the sermon with a prayer seeking the Lord’s guidance and blessing. The Prayers of the People of God, usually led by, but not limited to the pastor or vicar, give us an opportunity to offer specific petitions and needs to our Lord. In that prayer, there is also the opportunity for members to offer petitions in their heart, or even better, out loud. The prayer that our Savior taught us brings together all of our collective petitions. In services that offer Holy Communion, there is often a Eucharistic Prayer. Following the distribution, the post-communion prayer brings the sacrament to a close.

That’s a lot of prayer!

Prayer is a huge part of our worship. It provides numerous opportunities where we can share our thoughts with God AND also be listening for what God may be saying to us.

On this National Day of Prayer (and the other 364 days), I encourage you to use the gift of prayer to speak with your Heavenly Father and hear Him speak to you.

Dr. Wallace Horton,
Minister of Worship and Music

Stewardship Message

Living Savior's Stewardship program for this year is focused on the education and encouragement of all of us as church members to practice good Christian stewardship. During the past two years the approach entailed helping us understand stewardship concepts and practices of faithful Christian living. Stewardship is more than giving money, which is, of course, important for the programs of Living Savior to succeed.



Since our Commitment Sunday, Pastor, Vicar and Dr Horton have been preparing monthly Stewardship letters. These letters provide a sound theological basis for good Christian stewardship. I know we all get a lot of mail and it's sometimes hard to keep up with; however, please take the time to read the monthly stewardship letters as they provide a biblical focus and insight for Christian living and stewardship.

Scholarships for Lutheran College Students and Seminarians

The Bethesda Lutheran Communities Auxiliary, in partnership with AbleLight, is offering \$15,000 in student scholarships for the 2022-23 school year. The scholarships are for undergraduate- or graduate-level students, including seminarians.

"We're pleased to support young men and women who hope to put their talents and energy toward enhancing the lives of people with intellectual and developmental disabilities," said Gail Nicolaus, president of Bethesda Lutheran Communities Auxiliary. "Furthering the achievements of students who have a shared interest in supporting the AbleLight mission helps us all. It's gratifying to be able to empower these students in such a direct way."

The deadline to apply is May 13, 2022, with results to be announced by July 1, 2022. To download an application, go to

<https://ablelight.org/get-involved/auxiliary/scholarships/>.

Download Application

Seminarian/Post-Graduate Student Scholarships

Scholarships will be awarded to a Lutheran seminarian(s) or post-graduate(s) displaying interest in service to people with intellectual and developmental disabilities in a congregational setting. The scholarship application is open to all eligible seminary/post-graduate students.

Criteria:

- Be an active, communicant member of a Lutheran congregation.
- Be a current college senior, or a person accepted to begin seminary or post-graduate studies in the fall, or currently be classified as a first-year or second-year student at any Lutheran seminary. Students going on to their internship/vicarage year do not qualify.
- Have a commitment to inclusion of people with intellectual and developmental disabilities within the local parish.

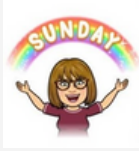
College and university student scholarships

Scholarships will be awarded to junior and senior students pursuing undergraduate degrees in any academic area that will prepare them to serve and support people with intellectual and developmental disabilities.

Criteria:

- Be an active, communicant member of a Lutheran congregation.
- Be classified as a junior or senior at an accredited 4-year college or university.
- Have a minimum overall GPA of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale.
- Have a career objective in the field of ministry with people living with intellectual and developmental disabilities.

Bible Studies /Sunday School / Groups

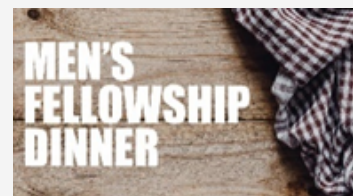


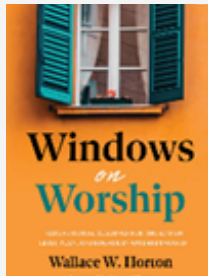
We welcome all school age children to a fun-filled time learning about Jesus. The unit this fall focuses on Jesus' birth, growing up, and many of his miracles. Primary class is for PreK-Grade 1. Upper elementary is for Grades 2-5. We will meet between services from 10:00 to 10:45 in the Preschool wing. Please email Jean-Marie Galing to register your children.



Confirmation Class, Between Services Sundays Contact: Pastor Andy or Vicar Scot

Men's Christian Fellowship Dinner – 4th Thursday of the Month, at 6 pm in Klein Hall





Living Savior Men's Fellowship Study, Breakfast at 7:30am and study 8am – 9:30am, 2nd and 4th Saturdays. The new study series starting in November will be based on the book "Windows on Worship" by Dr Wallace Horton. The Men's Fellowship will provide the books for study. Study also available virtually, contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Living Savior Men's Fellowship Happy Hour, 1st and 3rd Friday evenings. Contact Paul Gross for Zoom address

Men's Happy Hour
By Zoom

Events at LSLC



Voter's Meeting

Our regularly scheduled Voters' meeting will be July 17th at 9:30AM in Klein Hall.

VBS !!!

July 18 - 22, 2022

We are very grateful Wendy McGraw has volunteered to step in for Sarah Loesch as Sarah goes through her cancer treatments. We are so very excited to have this opportunity for all the children. There are many opportunities to help.



Specific needs already identified are:

- Teachers
- Group Leaders
- Craft / Food / Bible Story Leader
- Prep volunteers (don't need to be at VBS. Help buy and prep craft, snacks and decorations)

Southwest themed decorations would be appreciated. Items like blankets, catus themed items, or rustic camping gear. Help us get creative.

Crews for ages 3 to rising 5th graders will have a week going on an off-road adventure with God. Songs, Snacks, Crafts, and Bible Stories for all. Invite your neighbors and your children's friends. The cost is \$40 per child or \$80 for a family to cover the costs.

We are encouraging volunteers including youth that are rising 6th graders and older. We have a VBS website for registration of participants and volunteers. Please click the link to register. <https://vbspro.events/p/events/lslcvbs>

**Church Picnic
Sunday June 11th
Time: TBD**



We are planning a Church Picnic this year with lots of food and fellowship. More information to follow. If you are interested in volunteering to help, please contact Steve Galing.



**Vicar Hail / Fairwell
Tentative Date: July 30th
Klein Hall**

Our next vicar has just received his new call and the congregation is in the process of setting up arrival for Luke Onken and departure dates for the Messling family. Tentatively, LSLC is planning our traditional potluck Vicar Hail/Farewell for Saturday, July 30th. If you would like to help, contact Steve or Bonnie Thomas.



Social Ministry

Contact Miki Kolton ekolton@gmail.com & Steve Thomas bandsthoras@verizon.net

We are planning for the coming months and need help from members of Living Savior. Many hands make light work. Please review the opportunities to be the hands and feet of Christ as we work to serve our neighbors in need. Please contact Miki or Steve if you are interested in working on any of these projects. For all projects, financial assistance is welcomed.

August: Back-to-School

Backpacks and Supplies



LSLC is supporting 3 shelter locations and will be providing backpacks & supplies for the children and Walmart & gas gift cards for the moms.

Domestic Violence Shelter
Artemis House



Nov: Thanksgiving Baskets
Domestic Violence Shelter
Artemis House

Dec: Angel Tree & Holiday Party

Domestic Violence
Shelter Artemis House



Move-out / Move-In

Kits



There is an ongoing need to help set up new homes as families move out of shelters. Providing food, kitchen and laundry supplies

Lamb's Center

daytime drop-in
homeless shelter

Concordia Food Ministry



Feb: FACETS Hypothermia Shelters



Nov: Operation Christmas Child



Oct: Crop Walk

Raises funds to help neighbors near and far get the clean water and meals they need today and sustainable food security for tomorrow.

Afghan and Ukrainian Refugee Relief & Resettlement Ongoing



**Lutheran Immigration
and Refugee Service**

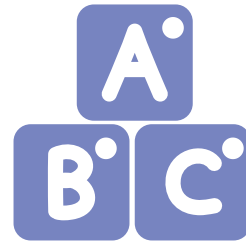
Outreach

- **What's happening sheet** – If you want to see what is happening in May/June/July go to the LSLC website under Announcements to download the LSLC Outreach Information Sheet. Good to pass on to neighbors, family or friends who may be looking to get involved in the LSLC activities.
- **Greeters** – If you are interested in becoming a greeter at services, please contact Ric Weyrick or Bob Willuweit

Opportunities to Serve

- **USHERS!!! We NEED USHERS** – Since many of the congregation are safe-at-home, we need those who can to help as Ushers. For Sunday 8:30 or 11am service Ushers, see Pastor Andy since he will be looking for volunteers for the upcoming months soon.
- **Altar Guild** - Please consider helping with altar guild duties. Teams are on a rotating schedule. Within each team, member decide how they will execute the month's responsibilities so that the schedule is convenient. Free training! Flexible schedule! Many hands make light work! If you would like additional information, please contact Pam Belch: pcbelch@comcast.net
- **Lay Crucifiers** - we have returned to using lay crucifiers at both in-person worship services. All lay people (men and women) middle-school age and older are welcome to service as crucifiers. All must complete a short training prior to serving. To volunteer / schedule your training session. Please contact Dr. Horton
- **Chancel Choir** - The Chancel Choir resumed rehearsals on Wednesdays, 7:30pm in the sanctuary. Membership is open to singers high school age or older. The ability to read music is helpful but not required. If you are interested in being a member, please contact Dr. Horton.
- **Modern Worship Ensemble** - The Modern Worship Ensemble rehearse Tuesdays at 7:30 . If you are interested in participating, please contact Candie Jefferson
- **Lay Readers** - If you are a trained Lay Reader and would like to read in the upcoming months, please see Dr. Horton to select a date(s) to read. If you have not received training to be a Lay reader but would like to become a Lay Reader, please see Dr. Horton so that you can receive training.
- **Live Streaming operators** - Help get the digital message out to those watching live stream worship. We are especially encouraging teens who have digital skills. Contact Pastor Andy

Living Savior Preschool



May Happenings

During the month of May, the children will be exploring reptiles, dinosaurs and thanking God for their mothers and fathers. We will be celebrating Cinco de Mayo in the classrooms on May 4th and 5th.

During the children's chapel lessons, they will be learning about Noah and the flood and Jesus' ascension into Heaven. The preschool year will wind down with their end of year parties on May 26th and 27th.

Spring Program

On the afternoon of Wednesday, May 18th at 12:00 p.m. the LSP children will perform some songs for their parents followed by a "Kindergarten send-off" for children going to kindergarten next year. After the program the parents will be able to visit and enjoy some refreshments together in Klein Hall.

Registration

Registration for the 2022-2023 preschool year is ongoing. We have spaces available in all of our classes ranging from 2 ½ year olds to Pre-K. If you are interested or know someone who may be interested in registering, please call the preschool office at 703-352-4208 or email Miss Terri at preschool@livingsaviorlutheran.org for information or stop by the office and pick up a brochure.

Summer Camp

Once again we will have our Summer Camp Program here at Living Savior Preschool for the week of May 31st to June 3rd. Registration is currently full. The theme for the week is Dinosaurs and will be led by LSLC members Sarah Loesch and Lisa Smith, pending health issues. If anyone is interested in helping volunteer for the week of summer camp, please contact Miss Terri in the office.

Opportunities to Worship

- Sundays 8:30am, **Traditional Worship**, Holy Communion 1st and 3rd Sundays
- Sundays 11:00am, Traditional Worship when not Modern Worship, Holy Communion 2nd and 4th Sundays, **Modern Worship Services** – selected May 22 and June 26

On-Line Worship Opportunities - Sunday 11:00am service live-streamed and available for later viewing, see LSLC Website for details
<http://www.livingsaviorlutheran.org/>